Product teardown, Indian mobility

Namma Yatri Rapido

Namma Yatri vs Rapido, *two bets on Indian mobility*

Namma Yatri is building mobility as public infrastructure. Rapido is building it as a product it owns.

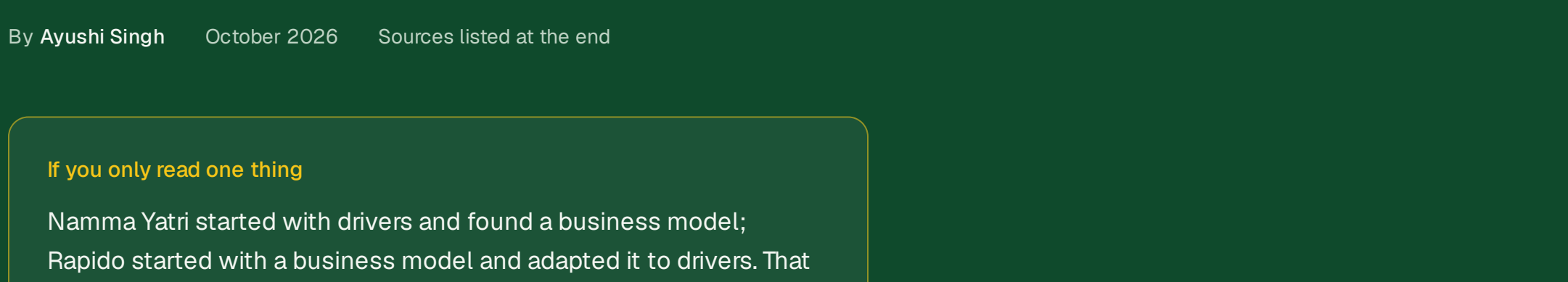
Both now pitch zero commission to drivers, so price is no longer what separates them. The real split is an open network that anyone can plug into versus a platform that controls the whole loop.



By **Ayushi Singh** October 2026 Sources listed at the end

If you only read one thing

Namma Yatri started with drivers and found a business model; Rapido started with a business model and adapted it to drivers. That choice explains their pricing, their UX trade-offs, and what protects each of them.



Every weekday at Silk Board junction. Same traffic, two very different bets on how to get through it.

At a glance

Two companies, *four differences*

	Namma Yatri	Rapido
Started as	Juspay spin-off Bengaluru, 2022	Bike taxis Bengaluru, 2015
Driver model	Zero commission Flat platform fee	Hybrid Commission plus daily fee
Network	Open Built on ONDC	Owned Closed platform
Reach	A handful of metros Bengaluru, Delhi-NCR, Chennai and more	400+ cities Nationwide

Rapido is far larger. This teardown compares strategies, not size.

Business model

Same pitch, *different engines*

Namma Yatri has only ever run one pricing model at a time. Rapido runs two in parallel, split by vehicle type.

Namma Yatri

Supply-first, one model at a time

Nov 2022
Free for drivers
Launched on ONDC with no commission and no fee, backed by Bengaluru's auto drivers' union.

→

The problem
Free doesn't scale
Engineering, operations, marketing and R&D costs kept rising.

→

Sep 2023 to today
Subscription
₹25 a day, or ₹3.5 per ride for the first 10 rides. Still zero commission; the driver keeps the full fare.

Rapido

Demand-first, then adapted

2015
Commission
Bike taxis first. Rapido kept 20% of each fare; the captain kept 80%.

→

The problem
Drivers pushed back
Commission frustration, plus Namma Yatri's zero-commission pitch to auto drivers.

→

Feb 2024 to today: autos and cabs
Subscription
A daily access fee of roughly ₹9–29, depending on the city.

Feb 2024 to today: bike taxis
Still commission
Kept for part-time captains who do only a few rides a day.

Why commission still suits bike taxis

Many bike captains are part-time, doing two or three rides a day around a job or classes. With commission, you only pay when you earn.

A flat fee on a slow day takes a big bite out of a small income. Auto drivers are full-time and high-volume, so for them a flat fee is far cheaper.

Namma Yatri solved the same problem inside one model

Its per-ride option caps at ₹35 a day, so low-volume drivers aren't punished. Break-even sits around seven rides.

Rides a day	Per ride	Daily
3	**₹10.5**	₹25
7	**₹24.5**	₹25
8	₹28	**₹25**
15	₹35 (cap)	**₹25**

Namma Yatri started with drivers and found a business model. Rapido started with a business model and adapted it to drivers.

Fee figures are the launch rates reported in 2023–24. Both companies vary plans by city, so check current terms locally.

User journeys

Half the steps are identical. *The rest tell the story.*

Basic ride booking is a solved pattern. Every difference shows up at the same three moments: choosing, pricing, and getting paid.

Rider books a ride

Differs · Same on both

		Namma Yatri	Rapido
1	Open app and log in	Phone number and OTP	
2	Current location	Detected by GPS, pin can be adjusted	
3	Enter drop location	Search or pick on the map	
4	Confirm pickup point	Confirm or move the pickup pin	
5	**Choose vehicle**	Auto or cab	Bike, auto, cab, or parcel
6	**See fare estimate**	Government-regulated fare, no surge	Platform-set, dynamic fare
7	Book ride	Request goes to nearby drivers; optional tip to speed it up	
8	Driver assigned	Driver details, vehicle number, live ETA	
9	Start ride	Rider shares OTP with the driver	
10	During ride	Live tracking, SOS, trip sharing	
11	**Pay**	Directly to the driver, cash or UPI	In-app wallet, UPI, or cash
12	**Rate**	Rate the driver; save as a favourite	Rate the captain

Driver joins and earns

Differs Same on both

	Namma Yatri	Rapido
1 Download driver app	A separate app for drivers (Rapido calls them captains)	
2 Sign up	Phone number and OTP, choose a language	
3 **Select vehicle type**	Auto or cab	Bike, auto, or cab
4 Upload documents	Licence, vehicle RC, ID, photo	
5 Verification	Documents checked before going live	
6 **Pick a plan**	Daily or per-ride subscription only	Bike: commission. Auto and cab: subscription
7 Go online	Toggle availability	
8 **Receive request**	Chooses trips; can raise the fare up to 10% at peak hours and night	Platform-led matching
9 Pickup and OTP	Navigate to the rider, verify the OTP	
10 Complete ride	Drop the rider, end the trip	
11 **Get paid**	Full fare, directly from the rider	Bike: fare minus commission. Auto and cab: full fare

Namma Yatri gives drivers control. Rapido gives riders convenience.

Steps marked as the same reflect standard ride-hailing flows and public app listings; exact screens may differ by city and app version.

UX observations

Where each app *shines and stumbles*

The strengths cluster on opposite sides of the marketplace: Namma Yatri's on the driver side, Rapido's on the rider side.

Rider side

	Namma Yatri	Rapido
Choosing	Works Few options, quick decision	Works More choice; bikes beat traffic
Pricing	Works Fare trust, no surprise surges	Friction Dynamic fares can feel unpredictable at peak
Matching	Friction The tip loop: wait, raise the tip, wait again	Works Large captain base, faster matches

Driver side

	Namma Yatri	Rapido
Choosing	Works Picks trips, fewer cancellations	Friction Less control; platform-led
Pricing	Works Can raise fares up to 10% at peak and night	Friction No fare-setting power
Getting paid	Works Full fare, transparent	Friction Under commission, sees only their payout, not what the rider paid

Each app's biggest UX problem is the flip side of its biggest strength. Driver control on Namma Yatri means riders pay in wait time. Platform control on Rapido means drivers pay in trust.

Strategy and moats

How each plays, *and what protects it*

Five strategic choices explain how each company grows. The moats come out of those choices.

Choice	Namma Yatri	Rapido
Entry wedge	Autos in Bengaluru, launched with drivers	Bike taxis, a cheap, high-frequency category incumbents ignored
Supply strategy	Union-led, built with the auto drivers' union	Pricing-led, moved autos to a daily access fee to win drivers
Growth approach	Organic, with no rider discounts or driver incentives	Capital-led, raising to expand into cabs against Ola and Uber
Expansion model	Regional brands per state and government partnerships, such as Kolkata's yellow taxis	Wide and fast, now in 400+ cities
Revenue expansion	Stays focused on mobility	Puts idle captains to work on deliveries and food

Moats and risks

Namma Yatri

Moat

Driver trust

It grew out of a union partnership. Drivers see it as theirs, which a VC-funded rival can't easily copy.

Moat

Government alignment

ONDC roots and state partnerships, like running Kolkata's taxis as Yatri Sathi.

Risk

Its pricing edge got copied

Ola, Uber and Rapido have all adopted similar subscription plans, and the union has said it's no longer consulted as it once was. Fairness alone stops being a reason to switch.

Rapido

Moat

Scale

More captains mean faster matches, which bring more riders, which bring more captains.

Moat

Owning bike taxis

It's the largest bike-taxi player, the category it created.

Risk

Regulation

Karnataka banned bike taxis in 2025. The High Court lifted the ban in January 2026, but the state has appealed to the Supreme Court and resumed seizing bike taxis in August 2026.

Where Namma Yatri is headed

New cities, stronger tech infrastructure, and deeper ONDC partnerships, with the ambition of being a "UPI for mobility".

Where Rapido is headed

More services through the same captains, and preparation for a public listing.

Namma Yatri grows like a public utility: slow, trusted, partner-led. Rapido grows like a startup: fast, funded, and expanding into anything its captains can carry. Trust is hard to buy but easy to outspend; scale is easy to buy but exposed to regulation.

PM take

What I'd *build next*

One fix for each company's biggest friction, and one bet on its biggest strength.

Namma Yatri

Make waiting feel fair

- **Break the tip loop.** Show riders a suggested tip and a likely wait time up front, so they choose once instead of raising the tip repeatedly.
- **Turn open data into driver tools.** Use the public dashboard to show drivers where demand is building, so the trust advantage also becomes an earnings advantage.
- **Metric to watch:** time from booking to driver accept.

Rapido

Make earnings feel fair

- **Show commission captains the full fare.** Display what the rider paid and Rapido's cut on every trip, closing the trust gap at no extra cost.
- **Hedge the bike-taxi risk.** Keep shifting growth toward autos and cabs, where licensing is settled, so a court ruling doesn't hit the core.
- **Metric to watch:** 30-day retention of commission captains.

Sources

Reporting *this draws on*

1. TechCrunch, Google backs Namma Yatri (Jul 2024)
2. Venture Intelligence, Namma Yatri raises ₹39.75 Cr (2026)
3. MediaNama, Namma Yatri subscription charges (Aug 2023)
4. YourStory, Namma Yatri pilots taxi service (Apr 2024)
5. DT Next, Namma Yatri in Chennai
6. Deccan Herald, Namma Yatri and the drivers' union
7. MediaNama, Rapido subscription for auto drivers (Feb 2024)
8. Outlook Business, Rapido joins the unicorn club
9. Outlook Business, Rapido raises $200M
10. Hyring, Rapido company profile (2026)
11. MediaNama, Karnataka appeals bike-taxi ruling (Apr 2026)
12. Deccan Herald, Karnataka resumes bike-taxi crackdown (Aug 2026)
13. Deccan Herald, upfront tipping on ride apps

Product teardown by Ayushi Singh, October 2026.